

ENGLISH **LIVE**

50

COMPREHENSION & VOCABULARY

UPSC / BANK PO / SSC / OTHERS

SESSION - 50

11th APRIL, 2017

Punish Drunk Drivers, Not Legal Business

The Supreme Court errs in banning outlets that sell liquor within half a kilometre of a national or a state highway, except in towns with fewer than 20,000 residents. This violates the constitutional right of a lot of people to earn their livelihood without addressing the threat of drunken driving. Bars and restaurants that have obtained a proper licence to ply their trade, which includes serving liquor to patrons, now lose the right to operate just because of their prime location, for which they paid a premium. At the same time, irresponsible drinkers are as free to drive and destroy lives, theirs and others', as they were before. Collectively, social welfare stands reduced.

Banning the sale of liquor near a national or state highway is neither necessary nor sufficient for ending the menace of drunken driving. It is easy to demonstrate the insufficiency bit. If someone is determined to get a drink before setting off on a long drive, the distance of half a kilometre is no deterrence. Smartphone apps would soon sprout up that show the nearest liquor vend, wherever you are. Drunks who stagger out of a party at a home are untouched by the ban, as are those who treat a bottle as a driving accessory.

What is necessary is to prevent people who have alcohol in their blood in excess of a medically determined threshold from driving a vehicle. Stiff penalties, including the scrapping of their driving licence if caught driving under the influence, are one option. It might help to instal breathalysers at public places licensed to serve liquor, to help people check their alcohol levels before they decide to drive. Encouraging a business of temporary drivers who earn good money ferrying drunken would-be drivers in their own vehicles to their destinations is another idea.



THE ECONOMIC TIMES
Date : 3rd April, 2017

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DISCUSSION ON
11th April (Tuesday)

→
DISCUSSION ON
12th April (Wednesday)

BusinessLine

FRIDAY, APRIL 7, 2017

Too cautious

It is hard to fathom why the RBI has continued with its neutral stance, despite growth concerns

The Monetary Policy Committee has missed a chance to cut the repo rate, bite the bullet on non-performing assets, and give the economy the push it needed in the wake of demonetisation. It remains apprehensive of inflation while at the same time acknowledging that India's fundamentals as well as global confidence in its growth prospects remain sound; this is borne out by the surge in portfolio flows since February 2017 despite the Fed rate hike in December, a benign current account deficit of 0.7 per cent of GDP owing to a combination of moderate oil prices and a turnaround in exports, and a fiscal deficit that is well within limits. With global headwinds evidently having receded since 2016, and India's industry in need of a boost, it is inexplicable that the RBI should step back and leave the task of reviving the economy entirely to banks — expecting them to transmit the earlier cuts and leverage the surge in deposits post November 8. With investment trending at a five-year low, job-creation languishing in the organised sector in 2015-16, and sections of the Government conceding that the Q3 GDP numbers may not have captured the impact of demonetisation on the unorganised sector, the MPC should have signalled growth as its priority, especially as bank credit growth is at a historic low of barely 5 per cent. However, the policy seems singularly focused on mopping up excess liquidity with the banks in the wake of demonetisation (it has hiked the reverse repo rate) without really channelling it into the real economy, except stipulating higher investment in REITs (real estate investment trusts) and INVTs (infrastructure investment trusts). However, any increase in funds for these sectors would be subject to provisioning norms. Lower interest rates could have spurred productive forces by lowering the marginal cost of funds while also improving demand for housing and consumer durables. While savers certainly need protection, banks could have addressed that by improving returns for those who rely on interest income.

The MPC projects an inflation rate of 4.5 per cent in the first half of 2017-18 and 5 per cent in the second half, while pegging gross value added growth at 7.4 per cent, against 6.7 per cent in 2016-17. The threats to inflation, in its view, could arise from an indifferent monsoon, seventh pay panel payouts and prices of services. However, it appears that the MPC, perhaps burdened by its inflation-targeting mandate, is focused on prices at the expense of jobs and growth.

The RBI could also have been open on how much of the demonetised currency actually returned by December 31. Equally odd is its silence on how the sudden drop in currency in circulation in public, from ₹16 lakh crore on March 31, 2016 to about ₹12 lakh crore a year later, will be dealt with. Assuming that digital transactions will take time to bridge the gap, this shortfall may impact the economy. The policy approach needs to be less "neutral", going forward.

THE HINDU
BusinessLine
Date : 7th April, 2017

Punish Drunk Drivers, Not Legal Business

The Supreme Court errs in banning outlets that sell liquor within half a kilometre of a national or a state highway, except in towns with fewer than 20,000 residents. This violates the constitutional right of a lot of people to earn their livelihood without addressing the threat of drunken driving. Bars and restaurants that have obtained a proper licence to ply their trade, which includes serving liquor to patrons, now lose the right to operate just because of their prime location, for which they paid a premium. At the same time, irresponsible drinkers are as free to drive and destroy lives, theirs and others', as they were before. Collectively, social welfare stands reduced.

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wherever you are. Drunks who stagger out of a party at a home are untouched by the ban, as are those who treat a bottle as a driving accessory.

What is necessary is to prevent people who have alcohol in their blood in excess of a medically determined threshold from driving a vehicle. Stiff penalties, including the scrapping of their driving licence if caught driving under the influence, are one option. It might help to instal breathalysers at public places licensed to serve liquor; to help people check their alcohol levels before they decide to drive. Encouraging a business of temporary drivers who earn good money ferrying drunken would-be drivers in their own vehicles to their destinations is another idea.



Punish drunk drivers and not legal business owners

THE ECONOMIC TIMES

Date : 3rd April, 2017

Punish drunk drivers and not legal business owners

LIVE

- The Supreme Court **errs** in banning outlets that sell liquor within half a kilometre of a national or a state highway, except in towns with fewer than 20,000 residents. This violates the constitutional right of a lot of people to earn their livelihood without addressing the threat of drunken driving.
- Bars and restaurants that have obtained a proper licence to ply their trade, which includes serving liquor to **patrons**, now lose the right to operate just because of their prime location, for which they paid a premium. At the same time, irresponsible drinkers are as free to drive and destroy lives, theirs and others', as they were before. Collectively, social welfare stands reduced.
- Banning the sale of liquor near a national or state highway is neither necessary nor sufficient for ending the **menace** of drunken driving. It is easy to demonstrate the insufficiency bit.
- If someone is determined to get a drink before **setting off** on a long drive, the distance of half a kilometre is no **deterrence**.
- Smartphone apps would soon **sprout** up that show the nearest liquor vend, wherever you are. Drunks who **stagger** out of a party at a home are untouched by the ban, as are those who treat a bottle as a driving accessory.
- What is necessary is to prevent people who have alcohol in their blood in excess of a medically determined **threshold** from driving a vehicle. Stiff penalties, including the **scrapping** of their driving licence if caught driving under the influence, are one option.
- It might help to instal **breathalyzers** at public places licensed to serve liquor, to help people check their alcohol levels before they decide to drive. Encouraging a business of temporary drivers who earn good money ferrying drunken would-be drivers in their own vehicles to their destinations is another idea.



SUPREME COURT ORDER

- *Supreme Court banned liquor shops upto 500 mts on National and State Highways.*
- *Not only retail outlets, but hotels and bars will also be covered.*
- *Only exception is areas with a population of 20,000 or less.*
- *The liquor free zone is reduced from 500 mts to 220 mts in these areas.*

THE SUPREME COURT LIQUOR BAN

PROPONENT'S VIEW

- 1** Liquor on highways is resulting in several deaths on roads, hence it is the right move.
- 2** State is not able to control the proliferation of liquor on highways, hence the Supreme Court intervened under Article 142 to do complete justice.
- 3** When it comes to human lives, Right to Life is fundamental than anything else.
- 4** State agencies are not able to control drunken driving.
- 5** Liquor is outside the idea of commerce.
- 6** It exists solely at the discretion of policymakers without any concomitant fundamental right that other businesses enjoy.
- 7** Road accidents are crippling several families, hence it is the need of the hour.

THE SUPREME COURT LIQUOR BAN

OPPONENT'S VIEW

- 1** It is within the executive domain and it cannot come under Article 142.
- 2** As a policy matter, states have to decide whether prohibition is to be imposed or not.
- 3** If the Supreme Court feels that road accidents are on increase, then it can advise the state authorities to ensure breath analysers and other strict control measures.
- 4** States are permitting junk food, tobacco products and if liquor is causing public harm, they are also causing equal public harm.
- 5** Several lives are lost because of polluted water as the sewage is being led into rivers from cities and towns.
- 6** By applying same logic here also, the Supreme Court can enter. Then, where is the limit for such judicial overreach?
- 7** State is failing in several aspects and this is one of the failures and that cannot be the reason for violating the power balance as enshrined in the Constitution.

Punish drunk drivers and not legal business owners

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Err

*The judge **erred** in ruling
that the evidence was
inadmissible.*

**Err**

To make a mistake or to do something wrong

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Patron



*In the United States of America, most of the educational institutions run with the help of **patrons**.*

A person who gives financial/other support to a person/organization, or cause.

Patron



*There were some civil disturbances and police forced the restaurant **patrons** to leave immediately.*

A customer of a shop, restaurant, etc., especially a regular one.

Patron

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Menace

*The snakes are a **menace** to farm animals.*



Menace

A person or thing that is likely to cause harm/a threat or danger.

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3rd April, 2017

If someone is determined to get a drink before *setting off* on a long drive, the distance of half a kilometre is no *deterrence*.

Set off



*The couple **set off** their journey to Australia.*

Set off

To start on a trip



*I paid the money after **setting off** the amount due to us.*

Set off

The right to pay a person or organization less money than you owe them because they also owe you money

Deterrence

*India's nuclear policy is with the doctrine of "no first use" and our nuclear programme is only to act as a **deterrent**.*



Deterrence

The action or the fact of deterring people from doing something

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Sprout

*It takes 3 to 4 days for the seeds to **sprout**.*



Sprout

To produce leaves, hair, or other new developing parts, or to begin to grow

Stagger

*The person left the Hotel
Park Sheraton with a
drunken **stagger**.*



Stagger

Walk or move unsteadily, as if about to fall.

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Threshold

*In India the **threshold** for imposition of Income Tax is Rs. 2,50,000.*



Income Tax Department
Government of India

Threshold

The level at which something begins to happen

Scrap



*Govt. decided to **scrap** FIPB.*

Scrap

Discarded metal

Scrap

To not continue with a system

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